SUMMARY · MK 1 ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR & MANAGING PEOPLE · WEEK 5

Team Dynamics — Communication, Ego States & High-Performing Teams

How teams work: the cohesiveness vs performance-norm matrix, Tuckman's stages, five habits of high-performing teams, psychological safety, active listening, the power of words, and Eric Berne's Transactional Analysis (Parent–Adult–Child ego states).

Material

1 Team condition matrix: cohesiveness × performance norm

	Low performance norm	High performance norm
High cohesiveness	**"Dangerous" zone** — united around low standards.	**High Performing Team**.
Low cohesiveness	**"Grey" zone** — individualistic, low performance.	**"Agent" zone** — individualistic but performing.

Trick question: in the grey zone, should you raise cohesiveness? **Not yet** — you'd create the dangerous zone. **Raise the norm first** (grey → agent), then build cohesion (agent → high performing).

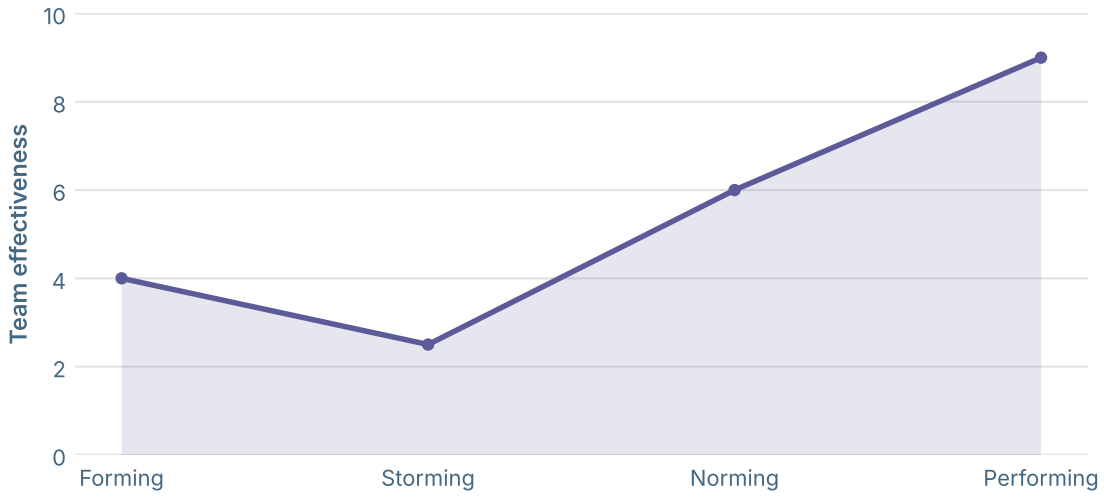
Tuckman: Forming → Storming → Norming → Performing → Adjourning. Storming conflict is normal.

2 Team development stages (Tuckman): why new teams dip first

Deep dive

Teams pass through forming, storming, norming, performing and adjourning; storming is normal.

Team performance by Tuckman stage (conceptual)



Conceptual: performance often dips in storming.

Stage	Leader's role
Forming	Clarify goals and roles
Storming	Surface and resolve conflict
Norming	Reinforce high-performance norms
Performing	Give autonomy
Adjourning	Celebrate, capture lessons

Link to cohesiveness × norms

Cohesion amplifies whatever norms exist.

3 Building a high-performing team

Five habits: communicate directly; make meetings matter; build relationships beyond work; a culture of appreciation in every direction; authenticity with psychological safety.

"Me" → "We" paradigm: individual growth mindset becomes collective; growth culture over genius culture; leaders shape it through policy, incentives and role modeling.

Psychological safety: the best teams *report more errors* — because they speak up, not because they fail more. Without it: silence, underreporting, repeated harm. Build a learning culture, not a blame culture.

4 Communication: active listening and the power of words

Active listening attunes to thoughts and feelings. Common failures: evaluating, probing, advising, interpreting; waiting to talk, checking your phone, saying "I get it" while missing the point. Good signs: eye contact, "What I hear you saying is...", clarifying questions, pausing before replying.

The 7–38–55 myth (Mehrabian). Called an urban legend (Lapakko, 2007) — the original study was narrow. Lesson: words, tone and body language must align.

Berger's magic words: similarity (linguistic fit — 3× more likely promoted), posing questions, emotion (roller-coaster stories), confidence/agency, concreteness ("30 minutes every Friday..." beats "be more innovative").

Workplace pillars: give context and why; balanced ego states; safety; active listening; fact-based criticism using **SBI (Situation–Behavior–Impact)**; complete asynchronous messages.

5 Transactional Analysis: Parent – Adult – Child ego states (Eric Berne)

An **ego state** is a way of expressing yourself in interaction; repeated, it becomes a pattern that can be analyzed and improved.

State	Traits	Example
Controlling Parent	Rules, commands, judging.	"Nobody leaves until this report is done."
Nurturing Parent	Caring, protecting.	"Not feeling well? Go rest, I'll cover."
Adult	Rational, fact-seeking, unemotional decisions.	"What data do you need from me?"

Natural Child	Spontaneous, playful, impatient.	"Love working with you!"
Adapted Child	People-pleasing, anxious, procrastinating.	"Yes ma'am, sorry..."
Little Professor / Rebellious	Creative, intuitive, sometimes manipulative/defiant.	"Ugh, can't we stop here?"

Transactions: *parallel* (expected response, smooth), *crossed* (unexpected state → conflict), *ulterior* (hidden message beneath the surface).

To exit a crossed transaction, **shift to Adult**; if that fails, ulterior transactions can save face. Key: analyze states, aim for parallel transactions, bring business to Adult, align words/tone/body, "I'm OK – You're OK", use all three states in balance.

6 Reading transactions: when communication flows and when it jams

Deep dive

Complementary
Response from the addressed state; talk flows.

Crossed
Response from another state; talk jams.

Ulterior
Hidden message behind a social one.

Example egogram of a manager

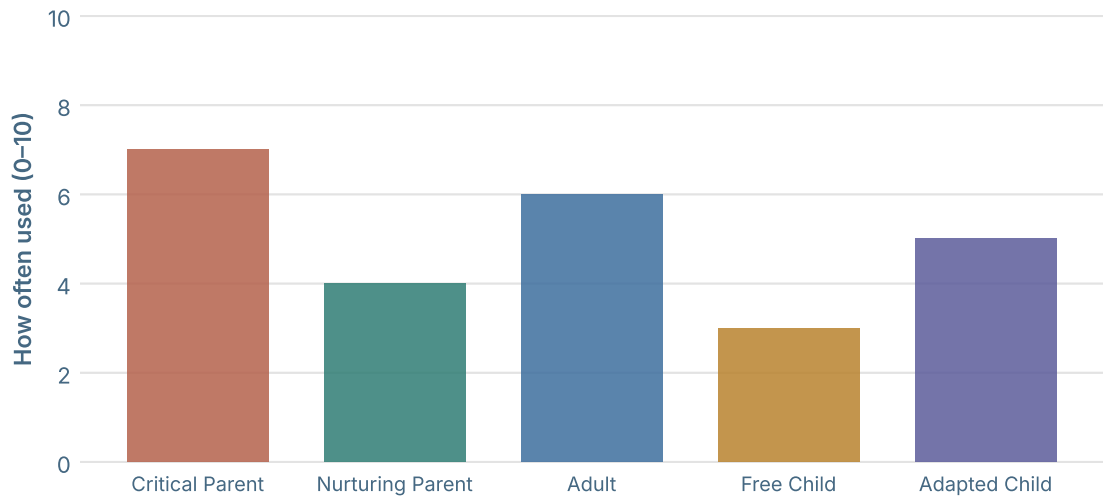


Illustration: a high Critical Parent pushes others into Adapted Child.

1. Recognise the other's ego state.
2. Don't get hooked.
3. Invite them to Adult with facts and questions.

Key takeaways

1. High cohesion + low norm = danger; raise the norm first.
2. Tuckman: forming → storming → norming → performing → adjourning.
3. Five habits: direct communication, meaningful meetings, relationships, appreciation, psychological safety.
4. Best teams report more errors because they feel safe.
5. Active listening: confirm, clarify, pause — don't judge or advise.
6. Use concrete, emotional, audience-matched language; criticize with SBI.
7. P-A-C ego states; parallel, crossed, ulterior transactions; shift to Adult to resolve conflict.

Case studies

Case & worked answers

Ego State exercise — with worked answers

Q1: "Your work is getting sloppier lately" → Critical Parent. "You're new, just follow our usual way" → Controlling Parent. "Do this report, don't mess up like yesterday" → Critical Parent.

Q2: All three ("I see sales metrics dropped — any obstacles?", "Let's compare pros and risks...", "I need this for tomorrow 2pm — what data do you need from me?") are **Adult** — the same messages as Q1, reframed.

Q3 — Budi vs Andi: Budi's public rebuke is Critical Parent → Child; Andi replies as Rebellious Child — a classic crossed transaction, worsened by loss of face. Fix: a facilitator de-escalates separately (Nurturing Parent); Budi reopens from Adult ("Feature X slipped 5 days — what's blocking, and how can Product help?"); Andi answers from Adult ("Three requirement changes added ~4 days; defer two and we can still ship"). Use SBI.

Q4 — New at a state construction company after P3MD: answer the boss from a confident, brief Adult; open with silent Mr. Rudi from Adult + Nurturing, respecting seniority (see Week 6) and asking to learn from his experience.

Practice questions

Try answering first. The answer key is below each question.

1. A new team starts arguing over roles. Which stage?

A. Forming
B. Storming
C. Norming
D. Performing

Answer: B. Storming.

2. Highly cohesive team with relaxed norms. Performance tends to be…

A. Very high
B. Low — cohesion reinforces weak norms
C. Unaffected
D. Always rising

Answer: B. Cohesion amplifies norms.

3. "When will the report be done?" — "You always push people!" This is…

A. Complementary
B. Crossed
C. Ulterior
D. Adult-Adult

Answer: B. Adult stimulus, Parent response → crossed.

4. Best response to a boss speaking from Critical Parent...

A. Angry reply
B. Comply resentfully
C. Stay Adult: facts and questions
D. Stay silent

Answer: C. Inviting Adult breaks the pattern.

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5. The leader's key role in forming is...

A. Full autonomy
B. Clarify goals, roles and rules
C. Avoid conflict
D. Disband

Answer: B. New teams need clarity.

Sources

- Week 5 Team Dynamics (Student Version).pdf
- Ego State Exercise.pdf